

UNDERSTANDING INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR



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AGENDA

- CONCEPT
- BEHAVIOR AS AN INPUT OUTPUT SYSTEM
- EMOTIONS, BELIEFS, ATTITUDE, VALUES NEEDS, MOTIVES AND BEHAVIOR AT WORK

Introduction

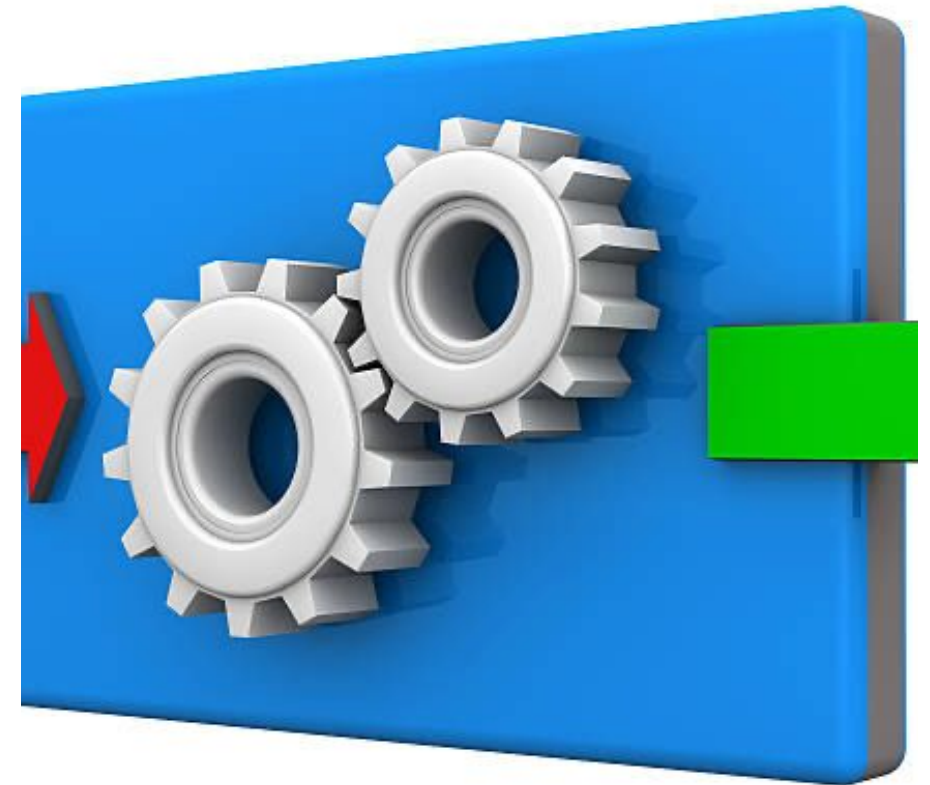
In an organization without understanding individual behavior organizational behavior becomes incomplete. Behavior is goal directed. Individuals are influenced by a number of diversified factors both genetic/inborn and environmental and the influence of these factor determines the pattern of behavior.

For the effective operation of an organization manager must know the individual behavior. Individual behavior is the result of interaction between individual characteristics and environmental characteristics by which behavior occurs.



It has been observed that each person's behavior is the result of intelligence, creativity , personality and adaptability etc. Both personal and environmental characteristics serves as the foundation of individual behavior.

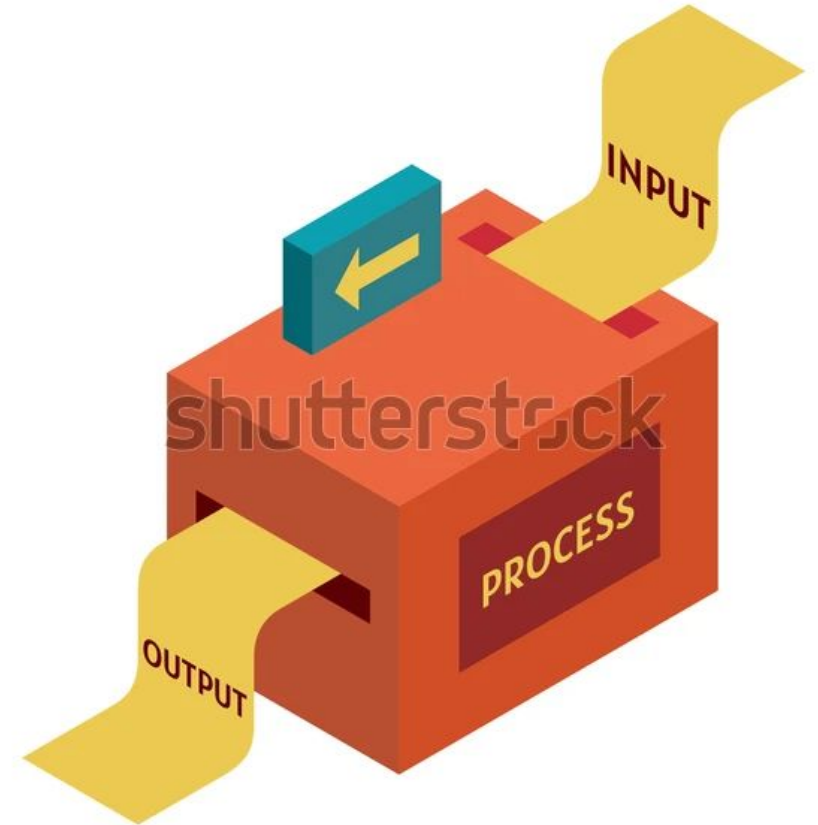
The input output system can be used as a conceptual framework for understanding individual behavior.



Individual Behavior

Input-Output System

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The Input

Stimuli forms the inputs for the individual behavior system. Stimuli can be internal and external.

Internal Stimuli: It consists of

Personal characteristics:

They are person-specific characteristics, age, gender and marital status, etc.

The widespread belief that job performance declines with the increasing age. However, turnover is generally lower with aging workforce. Married employees tend to have fewer absences and less turnover.

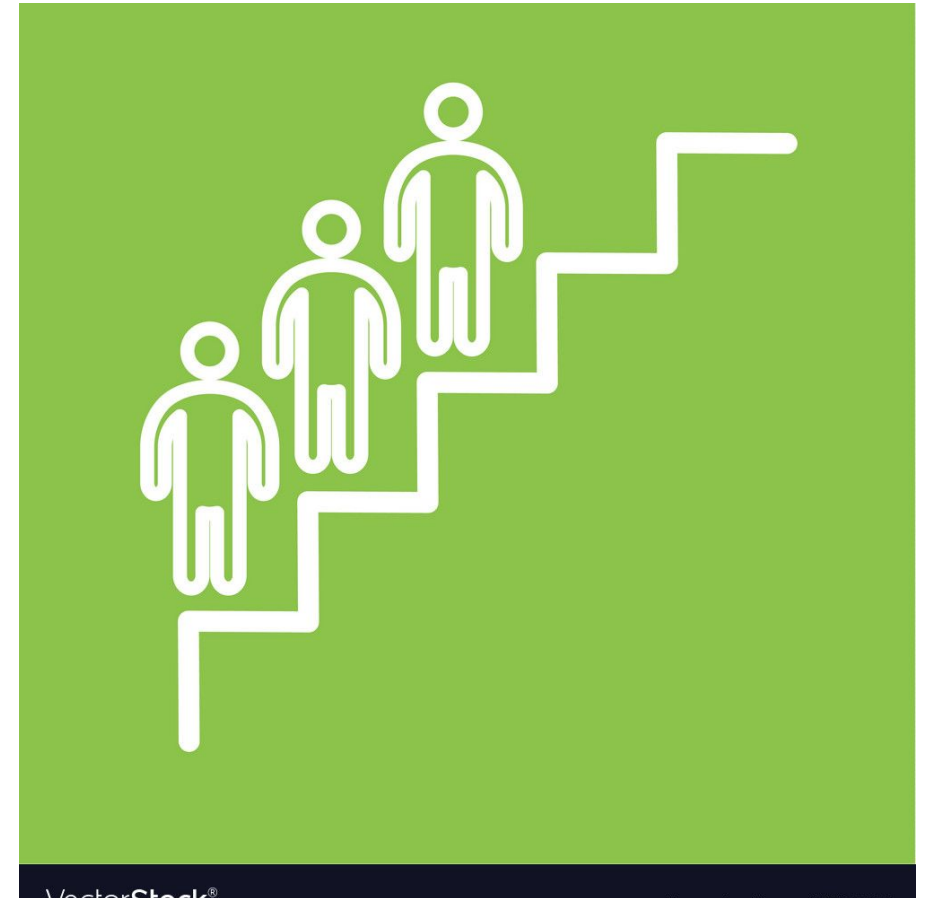


Personality:

Personality factors must be taken into account in determining the suitability of an individual for a position in an organization. It refers to personal traits or characteristics such as sociability, dominance, aggressiveness, persistence, etc. It is the some total of ways in which an individual reacts and interacts with others. It influences behavioral responses (a change in behavior in response to a stimulus).

Emotions:

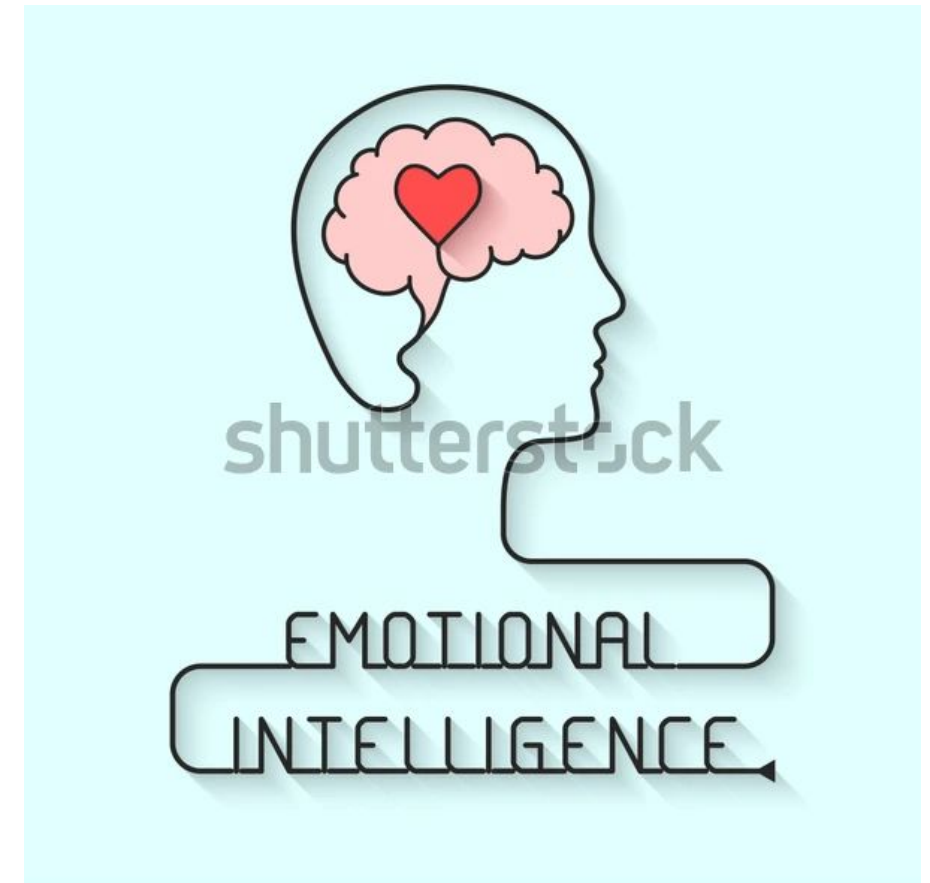
They are intense feelings that are directed at someone or something. They are reaction to an object.



Emotional Intelligence

Highly intelligent employees learn job-related skills and other organizational practices quickly, and organizations have to spend less time for training them. People with high intelligence have a good decision-making ability because of their good analytical and reasoning skills. They are very productive and have a high achievement drive. This is the age of emotional intelligence, and today's recruiting managers make sure that candidates have it. The five components of emotional intelligence at work are:

Self-awareness: Self-confidence, realistic



Self-regulation: Trustworthiness and integrity and openness to change.

Motivation: A strong drive to achieve, even in the time of failure, and organizational commitment.

Empathy: Expertise in building and retaining talent, cross-cultural sensitivity and service to clients and customers.

Social Skills: Effectiveness in leading change, persuasiveness and expertise in building and leading teams.



Values:

They represent the basic convictions of an individual as to what is right, good or desirable. They also influence an individual's motivation to obtain specific outcomes

Belief:

They are descriptive thoughts that an individual holds about something. It is based on empirical evidence. It builds from past experiences. They can be based on knowledge, opinion and faith. Individual should believe that positive consequences will follow from effective



Attitudes

It is a tendency to act in a certain way, either favorably or unfavorably concerning objects, people or events. Attitude has three elements that lead to measurable outcomes. These are feelings, thoughts and behavior.

In general, a person may have a positive attitude which means a good outlook of life, or negative attitude which means continuous complaining about problems in life. For example, if you showed a glass half-filled with water to A and B and asked them to describe it. (Optimist & Pessimist)



Ability

It is an individual's skills and capacities to perform various job related tasks. Abilities can be intellectual abilities to do skilled activities. It can be physical abilities to do less skilled activities. Ability is about aptitude and development opportunities.

Aptitude can be physical and mental. It is a person's built-in capacity to perform activities.

Development opportunities can be training, experience, learning etc.



External Stimuli

It consists of information which an individual receives from the external environmental forces.

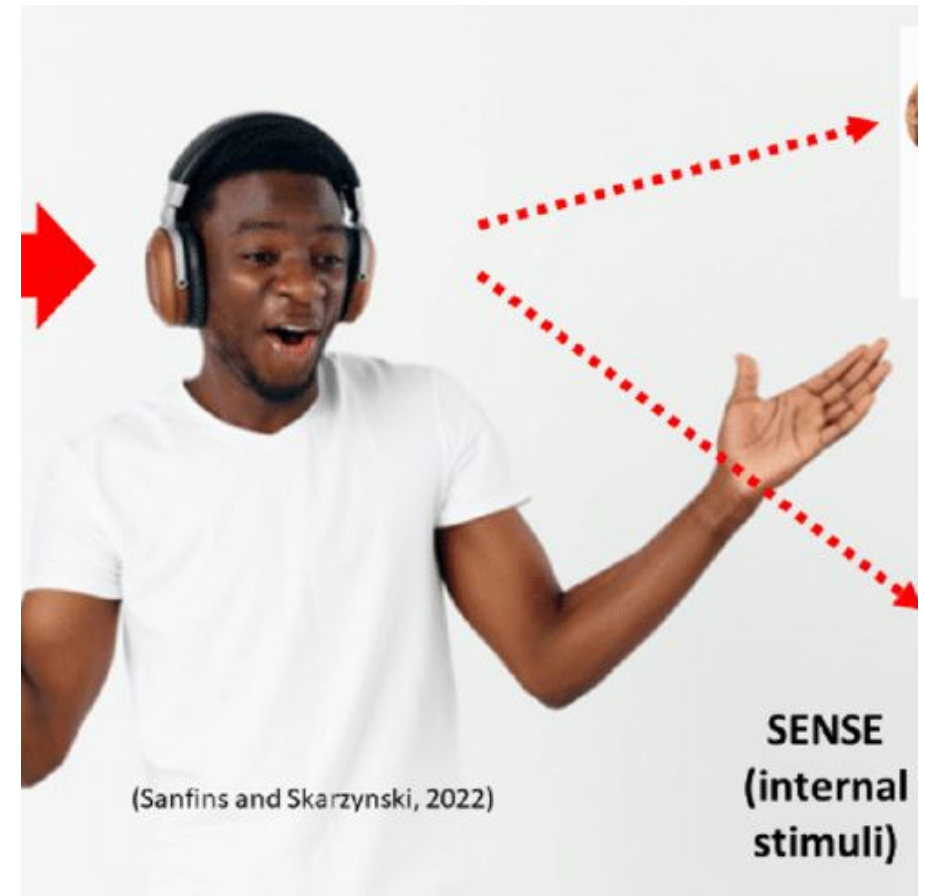
Physical forces:

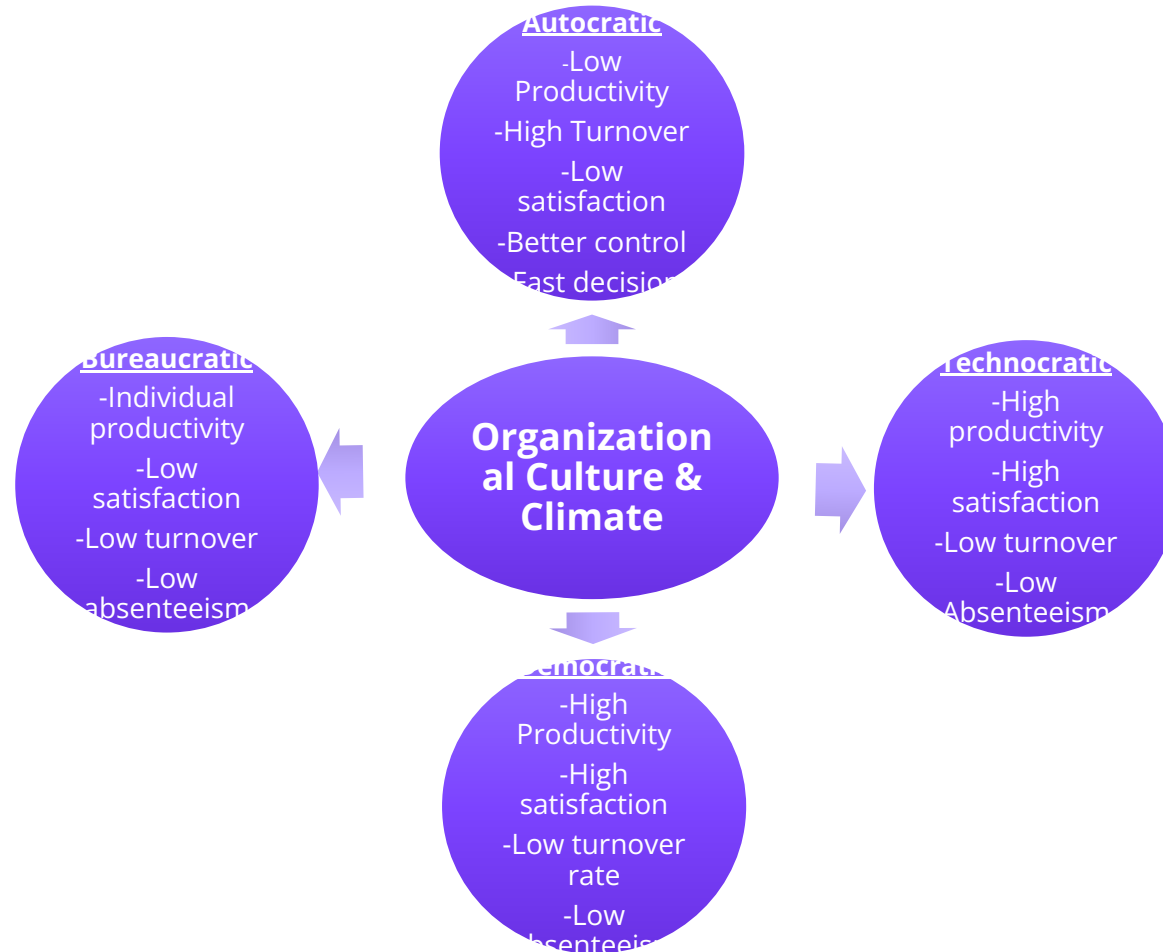
Climate, office environment, factory floor, laboratory, etc.

Socio-cultural forces:

Management styles, values, etc.

Organizational culture and climate also affect an individual's behavior at work. The various dimensions of organizational culture are values, ethics, beliefs, climate and culture. Organizational climate can be divided into following four categories.



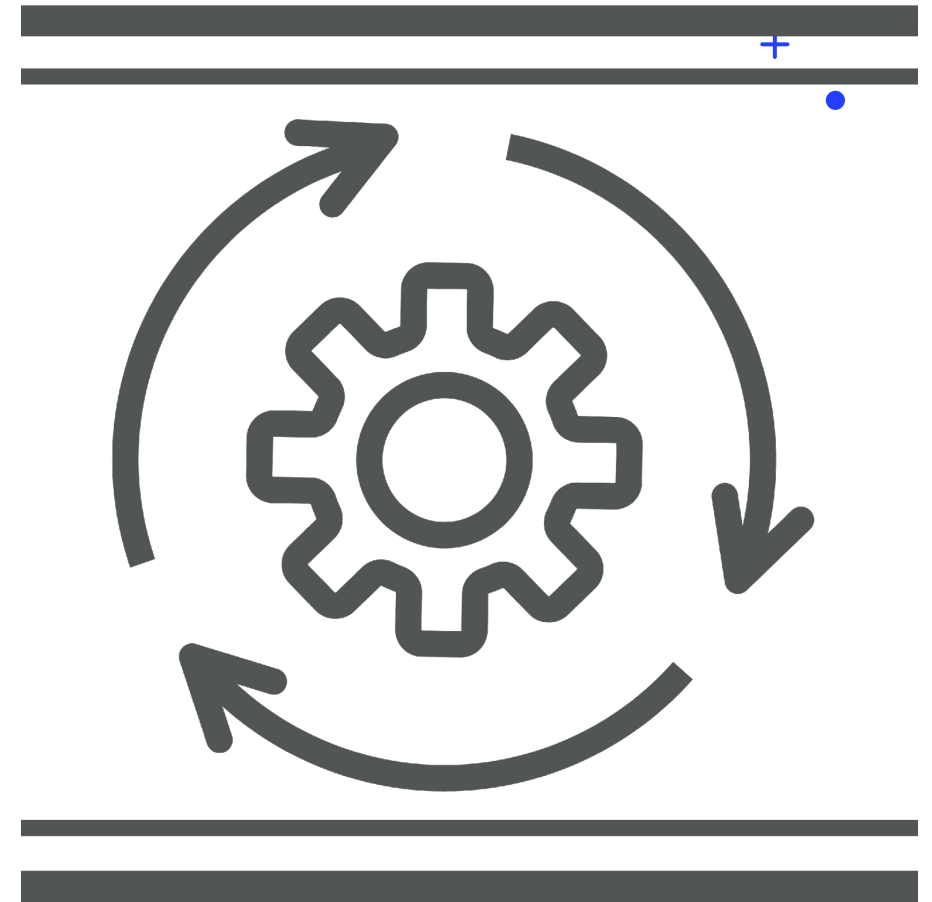


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Processing

It is the central processing function of individual behavior. It mediated between inputs and outputs of individual behavior system. It represents the cognitive understanding of the individual. It consists of:

- Physiological Processes
- Cognitive Processes
- Psychological Processes



Physiological Processes:

They are biological foundations of individual behavior. It influence the sensation. The individual sense the information from environment, interpret it and respond it.

Cognitive processes:

Cognition is the act of knowing an item of information. The cognitive process consists of: Perception, thinking, problem solving and decision making.

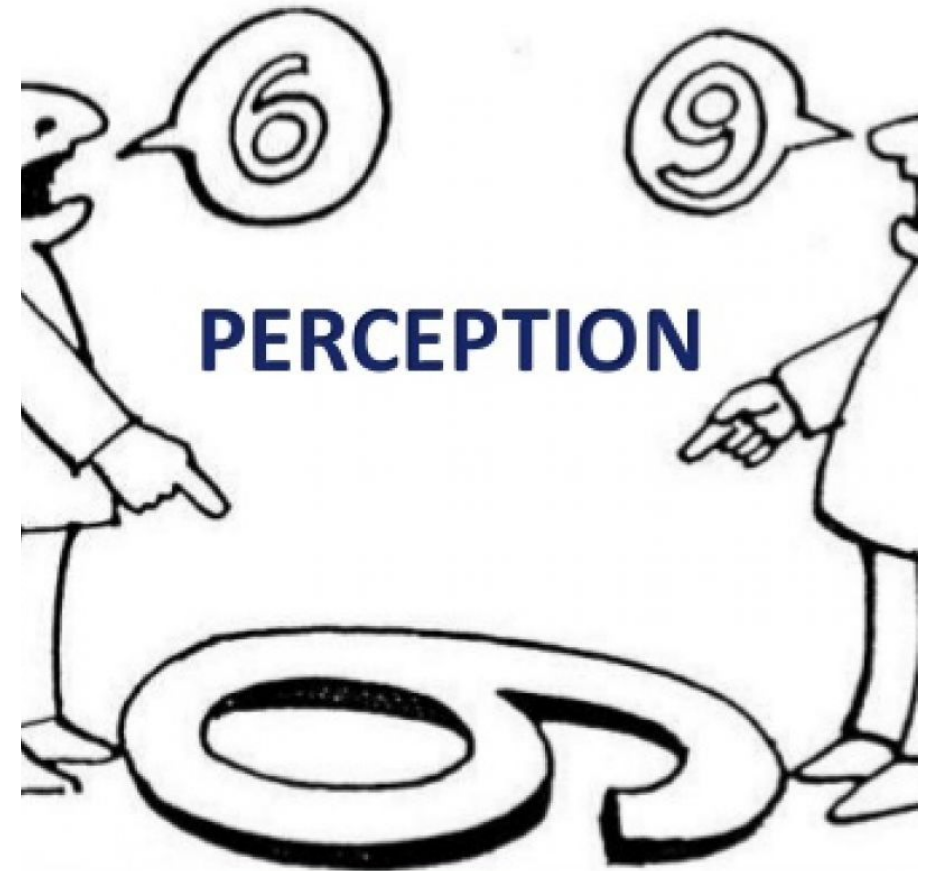


Perception:

It is a process by which individual organize and interpret their sensory impressions for giving meaning to the environment. Individual interpret information through perception. Individual behavior is based on the perception of what reality is, not the reality itself.

Perception is shaped by:

- The perceiver
- The target being perceived
- The perception environment



Thinking

It enables the individual to classify the information obtained from the environment.

Decision making

Decision making is choosing from among two or more alternatives. It involved:

- Gathering information
- Developing alternatives
- Making choice



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Psychological Processes:

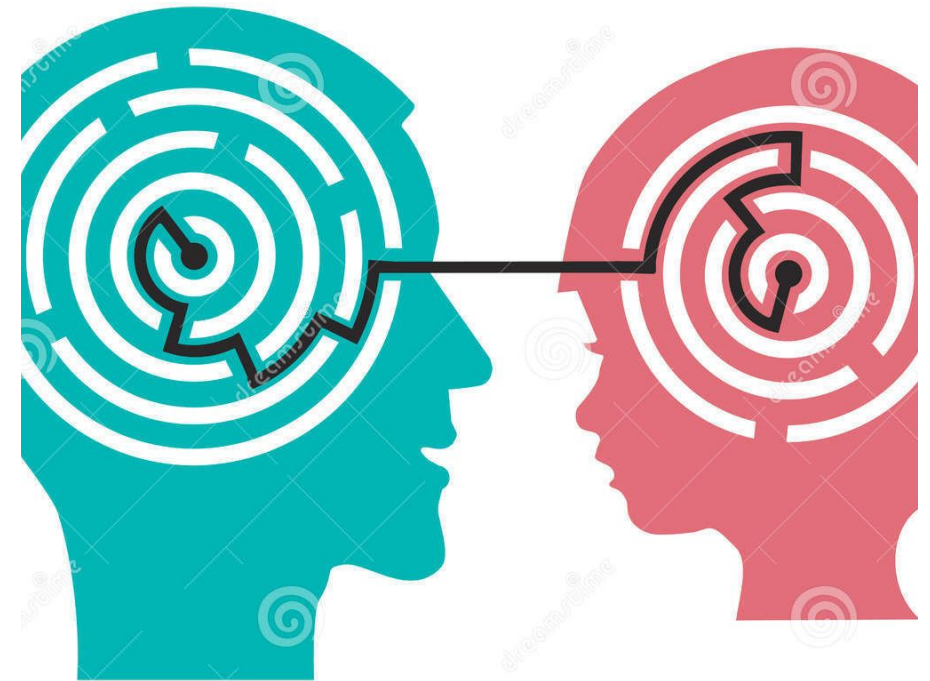
It consists of learning and motivation.

Learning

It is relatively permanent change in behavior as a result of information and experience.

Motivation

Happy workers are the productive workers. To make them happy proper motivation is essential. Motivation refers to all the forces operating within a person to cause him to engage in certain kinds of behavior rather than others. Motivation may be internal e.g. a person's skill, ability and intelligence; or external e.g., incentives, training, etc. Further, a person's motivation is influenced by this attitudes, beliefs, values and goals.



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Outputs

Outputs are the behavioral responses of individual behavior. They are caused by inputs and the processing components of individual behavior system.

Understanding, prediction and management of individual responses are essential for understanding, prediction and management of organizational behavior. The consequence of individual behavior leads to.....

- ❑ Increase in productivity
- ❑ Low absenteeism
- ❑ Low rate of turnover
- ❑ Increased job satisfaction
- ❑ Enhance organizational citizenship



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QUESTIONS